

Self-Awareness + Proactivity

10-Week Leadership Development Program

Daily Habit	Weekly Deliverable	Reading
Journal 3 emotional reactions each day. Label the emotion precisely.	Draw your Circle of Influence vs. Circle of Concern. Move one concern into influence by taking action.	HBR EI — 'What Self-Awareness Really Is' (Tasha Eurich) + The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People, Habit 1: Be Proactive (Stephen R. Covey)

Core Concept

The most critical leadership skill isn't strategic thinking or communication — it's self-awareness. Research by Tasha Eurich found that while 95% of people believe they are self-aware, only 10–15% actually are. This gap between perceived and actual self-awareness is the root of most leadership failures.

Self-awareness has two components: internal (knowing your values, emotions, patterns) and external (knowing how others perceive you). Both matter. Leaders with strong internal self-awareness make decisions aligned with their values. Leaders with strong external self-awareness build better relationships and earn more trust.

Proactivity, Covey's first habit, is tightly linked. Reactive leaders respond to events as they happen. Proactive leaders take responsibility for their responses. The 5-second pause — breathing before reacting — is the simplest neurological intervention to shift from reactive to proactive mode.

""Between stimulus and response there is a space. In that space is our power to choose our response. In our response lies our growth and freedom.""

— Viktor Frankl (cited by Covey)

Framework: Circle of Influence vs. Circle of Concern

Draw two concentric circles. The outer ring is your Circle of Concern — everything you worry about (the economy, your colleague's behavior, past mistakes). The inner circle is your Circle of Influence — what you can actually affect.

Reactive leaders spend their energy in the outer ring, feeling frustrated and powerless. Proactive leaders focus relentlessly on the inner circle, expanding their influence over time. Every time you take action on something within your control, your circle of influence grows.

Daily Practice

- Morning (5 min): Before checking your phone, write down your intention for the day. What kind of leader do you want to be today?
- During the day: Journal 3 moments when you felt a strong emotion (frustration, excitement, defensiveness). Write what triggered it and what you did.
- Evening (5 min): Ask: 'Where did I react vs. respond today? What would I do differently?'
- 5-second rule: Before responding to any criticism, feedback, or frustrating event — pause and count to 5. Feel the impulse to react, then choose your response.

Leadership Scenarios

Scenario 1

Your manager publicly criticizes your work in a team meeting.

Reflection: How do you respond in the moment? What do you feel? What would the proactive response look like?

Scenario 2

A colleague takes credit for an idea you developed together.

Reflection: What's your immediate impulse? Is that response in your circle of influence or concern?

Weekly Reflection Prompts

Set aside 20 minutes at the end of this week to write your responses. These are for you — be honest.

Reflection 1: Describe a recent situation where you reacted emotionally. What was the trigger? What story were you telling yourself?

Reflection:

Reflection 2: What is one item in your Circle of Concern that you have been treating as if it's outside your influence? What one action could move it inside?

Reflection:

Reflection 3: What are your top 3 values as a leader? When have you acted inconsistently with them this week?

Reflection:

Weekly Habit Tracker

Day	Done?	Notes / Observations
Monday	■	
Tuesday	■	
Wednesday	■	
Thursday	■	
Friday	■	
Saturday	■	
Sunday	■	

End-of-Week Summary

Reflection: What was my biggest leadership learning this week?

Reflection: What will I carry forward into next week?

Reflection: One relationship I invested in this week: